Edutechlife

MODULE 1 · PROMPTS

The Art of the Prompt

Anatomy of a prompt, the RTF formula, and how to improve it with every attempt

Module 1
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Teaching guide 2026
Teaching guide

edutechlife.co
Content 2026

Reviewed in October 2026

A prompt is the instruction you give an AI. The difference between a weak answer and a useful one usually comes down to **how much context** you give and **how you ask for the result**. This guide shows you how to write prompts that work from the first try.

RTF	4	3
Role, Task, Format	elements that complete a prompt	attempts to improve it

01 What a prompt is

A prompt is any instruction you write for an AI model. It can be a short question or a detailed brief. The model does not know what is in your head: it only has what you write. Whatever you leave out, it guesses.

CORE IDEA

A prompt is a brief to a very fast collaborator who does not know your context. The better you explain the job, the less you will have to correct.

02 The RTF formula

The RTF formula organizes any prompt into three basic parts:

R · Role

Who should answer. Example: “You are a high-school history teacher.”

T · Task

What to do, with a clear verb. Example: “Explain the Industrial Revolution.”

F · Format

How the result should look. Example: “Three short paragraphs and a table of dates.”

We add two elements that raise quality a lot: **context** (for whom, and why) and **constraints** (what it must not do). When you can, add an **example** of the result you expect.

03 Weak versus strong

Compare two prompts asking for the same thing. The difference is in the detail:

WEAK

PROMPT

```
Explain the Industrial Revolution to me.
```

STRONG

PROMPT

```
You are a high-school history teacher.
Context: my students are 15 years old and this is their first contact with
the topic.
Task: explain the causes of the Industrial Revolution in England.
Format: three short paragraphs and a table with the 4 main causes.
Constraints: do not use dates you are not sure of; if you are unsure, say
so.
```

04 Improving a prompt through iteration

Few people get it right on the first try, and that is fine. What matters is **improving with method**.



A good prompt is a clear instruction for a very fast collaborator.

1. **First attempt:** write the prompt with RTF. Review the answer without correcting it yet.
2. **Diagnosis:** what is missing? Tone, level, length, examples, concrete data?
3. **Second attempt:** add only what was missing. One change at a time tells you what worked.
4. **Compare and save:** if the result is useful, save the prompt as a template for next time.

05 Common mistakes

Mistake	Why it fails	How to fix it
Asking without context	The AI guesses the audience and level	Add who it is for and why
Asking for “something good”	“Good” has no measurable criteria	Define the format and length
Asking for many things at once	The answers get diluted	Split the brief into steps
Accepting data without checking	The model can be wrong with confidence	Ask for sources and verify figures
Pasting personal data	A risk to privacy	Anonymize before pasting the text

06 Ready-to-use templates

For studying

PROMPT

```
You are a patient tutor of [subject].
Explain [topic] to someone at [level].
Use an everyday analogy, one worked example and three questions to check my understanding.
```

For writing

PROMPT

```
You are a clear-writing editor for [audience].
Rewrite the text I paste so it is brief, free of jargon, and in a [tone] tone.
Keep every fact and tell me if you changed any.
```

For reviewing

PROMPT

```
Review this text the way a demanding evaluator would.
Give me three strengths, three concrete problems and one improvement for each problem.
```

07 One rule to close: what you should not paste

A prompt is a document that travels to an external service. Before you paste information, ask yourself whether you would share it with a stranger.

- [ ] Identity documents, passwords or bank details.
- [ ] Medical records or health information about other people.
- [ ] Personal data of students or minors.
- [ ] Confidential information from your company or clients.

In Colombia, the processing of personal data is governed by Law 1581 of 2012.

08 Practice exercise

1. Pick a real task from your week (an email, a summary, an idea).
2. Write a prompt with RTF and context. Note the answer.
3. Diagnose what is missing and improve the prompt in two attempts.
4. Save the final version as a template with blanks to fill in.

TO WRAP UP

- [ ] I write prompts with role, task and format, and I add context.
- [ ] I improve prompts one change at a time and compare results.
- [ ] I verify figures and sources before using an answer.
- [ ] I do not paste personal or confidential data into an AI.